2006 Toyota Corolla CE (likely manual)

$6,471 · 112,173 miles · Dealer · Bakersfield, CA

Seller: Bakersfield dealer (CarGurus; only 1 dealer review, 1.0)

Source: CarGurus

Listing: https://www.cargurus.com/details/462182322

Report generated October 30, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder









+ 1 more photos in the app.

Out-the-door price	Monthly cost to own	Reliability
$7,425	**$458**	**Good**
Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare.	loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration	4/5 · 10 recalls · 904 NHTSA complaints

Budget — buying it

Vehicle price	$6,471.00
Sales tax (9.25%)	$598.57
Dealer doc + filing fees	$125.00
Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price)	$42.06
Registration + CHP fee	$108.00
Transportation improvement fee	$65.00
Title transfer	$15.00
Total out-the-door	$7,424.63
+ Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop)	$150.00

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

Budget — paying for it

Down payment	$5,000.00
Amount financed	$2,424.63
Monthly loan payment (60 mo @ 7.5% APR)	$48.58
Total interest over the loan	$490.45
Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection)	$5,150.00

Budget — owning it each month

Loan payment	$48.58
Insurance (estimate, full)	$135.00
Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 29 MPG, $4.75/gal)	$163.79
Maintenance & repair reserve	$95.00
Registration renewal (÷12)	$16.01
Total per month	$458.38

Running costs without the loan: **$410/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$12,660** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

Insurance

Coverage	Typical Ridgecrest range	Estimate used
Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15)	$49–$112/mo	$70/mo
Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive)	$94–$243/mo	$135/mo

The budget above uses the **full coverage** estimate ($135/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: common sedan/hatch. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

Reliability

Rating: Good (4/5)

Good. The 9th-gen Corolla (2003-2008) with the 1.8L and 4-speed automatic is famously hard to kill, and this one has relatively low miles and a clean history.

NHTSA data for this model year: 10 recalls · 904 owner complaints (120 involving a crash). Most complaints: Air Bags (496), Engine And Engine Cooling (108), Electrical System (88), Vehicle Speed Control (77), Power Train (47), Service Brakes (37).

Known issues for this model

• Some 2005-2008 1.8L engines burn oil at high miles

• Water pump and A/C wear

• Basic, older safety equipment (side airbags optional)

Check on this car before buying

• Check the oil level and ask how often it's topped up

• A/C cold after 15 min

• Get dealer fees in writing (CarGurus says fees not disclosed)

• Run VIN for Takata airbag recall completion

Notes

$6,321 (fees not disclosed), 112,173 mi. NO accidents reported, clean title, 2 previous owners.

Dealer has a single 1-star review on CarGurus - get an independent inspection and the full out-the-door price in writing.

~2 hr drive from Ridgecrest (CA-178). Confirm availability and get an out-the-door price by phone/text before driving.

AutosToday lists this Corolla as 'CE Manual' (natl) - likely a MANUAL transmission. Confirm with the dealer; you'd need to drive stick.

2026-10-23: price went UP from $6,321 to $6,471 on CarGurus.

Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.